

The Straits

A strait is a narrow passage of water connecting two seas or two other large water bodies and simultaneously separating two landmasses. *The **Bering Strait** separates Asia from North America. The strait is 85 km wide and joins the Chukchi Sea (part of the Arctic Ocean) in the north to Bering Sea in the south. * **Gibraltar** separates Europe from Africa and joins the Atlantic Ocean to the Mediterranean Sea. ***Dover Strait** joins the English Channel to the North Sea. * The Dover Strait is located in the eastern part of the English Channel. Three underwater tunnels for railways have been built here to join England to France. ***Palk Strait** separates Tamil Nadu from Sri Lanka. It joins the Bay of Bengal (Palk Bay) to Gulf of Mannar. The strait is 64-137 km wide. Palk Strait has been named after Robert Palk who was the governor of Madras Presidency from 1763 to 1767. ***Hormuz Strait** is a strait between the Persian Gulf and the Gulf of Oman. Other important straits are-

Straits	Sea	Location
Malacca	Andaman Sea and South China Sea	Indonesia and Malaysia.
Sunda	Java Sea and Indian Ocean	Indonesia
Yucatan	Gulf of Mexico and Caribbean Sea	Mexico and Cuba
Otranto	Adriatic Sea and Ionian Sea	Italy and Albania
Cook	Tasman Sea and South Pacific Ocean	New Zealand (North and South Islands)
Mozambique Channel	Indian Ocean	Mozambique-Madagascar
North Channel	Irish Sea and Atlantic Ocean (Labrador Sea)	Ireland and England
Torres	Arafura Sea and Gulf of Papua	Australia and New Guinea Island
Bosporus	Black Sea and Marmara Sea	Turkiye
Davis	Baffin Bay and Atlantic Ocean	Greenland and Canada
Florida Strait	The Gulf of Mexico and the Atlantic Ocean	USA and Cuba
Magellan	The Pacific Ocean and the Atlantic Ocean	Chile

Makassar	The Java Sea and the Celebes Sea	Indonesia
Luzon	The South China Sea and the Philippine Sea	Taiwan Luzon Islands (Philippines)
Tartary	The Japan Sea and the Okhotsk Sea	Russia
Hudson Strait	The Hudson Bay & Labrador Sea (Atlantic Ocean)	Canada

Gulf of Bothnia is located between Finland and Sweden. ***Baffin Bay** is located in between Canada and Greenland. ***Gulf of Carpentaria** is in Australia. ***Gulf of Tonkin** is in between Vietnam and China. *Countries bordering the Persian Gulf are UAE, Bahrain, Saudi Arabia, Iran, Iraq, Kuwait and Qatar.

- Malacca Strait facilitates movement from –**
 - Indian Ocean to China Sea
 - Red Sea to Mediterranean Sea
 - Atlantic Ocean to Pacific Ocean
 - Mediterranean Sea to Black Sea

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (a)

Straits of Malacca runs between Indonesia and Malaysia. The Strait of Malacca connects Andaman Sea (Indian Ocean) to South China Sea. Thus, Statement (A) is correct.

- Between India and East Asia, the navigation time and distance can be greatly reduced by which of the following?**
 - Deepening the Malacca Straits between Malaysia and Indonesia.**
 - Opening a new canal between the Gulf of Siam and the Andaman Sea.**

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- 1 only
- 2 only
- Both 1 and 2
- Neither 1 nor 2

I.A.S. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (b)

Between India and East Asia, the navigation time and distance could be greatly reduced by opening a new canal between the Gulf of Siam and the Andaman Sea. Thus, only statement (2) is correct.

- Which Strait separates Europe from Africa?**
 - Bosporus
 - Gibraltar

(c) Dover

(d) Bering

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (b)

The Strait of Gibraltar separates Europe from Africa. It connects the Atlantic Ocean to the Mediterranean Sea.

4. Strait of Hormuz lies between –

- (a) Black Sea and Marmara Sea
- (b) Persian Gulf and Gulf of Oman
- (c) Arabian Sea and Red Sea
- (d) Red Sea and Mediterranean Sea

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2005

Ans. (b)

The Strait of Hormuz is located between the Persian Gulf and the Gulf of Oman.

5. The strait which separates Asia from North America is—

- (a) Bering Strait
- (b) Palk Strait
- (c) Strait of Gibraltar
- (d) Strait of Malacca

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (a)

Bering Strait separates Asia from North America. It is located at easternmost point of Russia at 169°43' east longitude and western end (Alaska) of USA at 168°05' west longitude. 85 km wide strait connects the Chukchi Sea (part of the Arctic Ocean) in the north with the Bering Sea (part of the Pacific Ocean) in the south.

6. Which one of the following waterways has more economic and strategic significance?

- (a) Pak strait
- (b) Malacca strait
- (c) Suez canal
- (d) Panama canal

M.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (c)

The "Suez Canal" is one of the world's largest artificial canals built in the Isthmus of Suez in Egypt. Due to the construction of this canal, the distance between Europe and India has been reduced by 7000 km. About 12% of global trade passes through it, representing 30% of all global container traffic annually. It is extremely important waterways because of its strategic location between Red Sea and Mediterranean.

7. The strait connecting the Arctic and Pacific Oceans is -

- (a) Bering
- (b) Torres
- (c) Dover
- (d) Malacca

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

8. Match the following:

A. Strait of Gibraltar

B. Strait of Malacca

C. Strait of Bering

D. Strait of Hormuz

i. Between Indonesia & Malaysia

ii. Between Gulf of Persia and Gulf of Oman

iii. Between Africa and Europe

iv. Between Asia and North America

Code :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	iv	ii	iii	i
(b)	iii	iv	i	ii
(c)	iii	i	iv	ii
(d)	iv	iii	ii	i

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) (Re. Exam) 2013

Ans. (c)

The correct match is as follows :

Strait of Gibraltar	– Between Africa and Europe
Strait of Malacca	– Between Indonesia and Malaysia
Strait of Bering	– Between Asia and North America
Strait of Hormuz	– Between Gulf of Persia and Gulf of Oman

9. Ten Degree Channel separates -

- (a) Andaman from Nicobar Islands
- (b) Andaman from Myanmar
- (c) India from Sri Lanka
- (d) Lakshadweep from Maldives

U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (a)

The Ten Degree Channel separates the Andaman and Nicobar islands in the Bay of Bengal. The two sets of islands together form the Indian Union Territory of Andaman and Nicobar Islands. It is so named as it lies on the 10° northern latitude.

10. Through which one of the following straits does a tunnel connect the United Kingdom and France ?

- (a) Davis Strait
- (b) Denmark Strait
- (c) Strait of Dover
- (d) Strait of Gibraltar

I.A.S. (Pre) 2007

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2007

Ans. (c)

Dover Strait marks the boundary between the English Channel and the North Sea. There are three marine tunnels through Dover Strait on the eastern part of English channel that connect England and France. These tunnels connect Folkestone in Kent of England with Coquelles in Pas-de-Calais France.